

Chapter 114_1 - Discord

The scene fell silent for a moment before erupting into a clamor. Many people rose to their feet, utterly unable to believe that the one standing high in mid-air, radiating evil aura, was the former young sect master Ning Fuyi who once had difficulty even cultivating immortality.

"I'm not dreaming, am I? That's really Ning Fuyi?" Feng Ge grabbed Liu Wenzhu's hand in bewilderment, standing up somewhat at a loss. "Chuwei Hall¹ master? What kind of joke is this?"

Liu Wenzhu Rongjin was naturally even more shocked than her. The two stood and sat respectively, their expressions shifting like storm clouds, unable to believe it no matter what.

"Yiyi she..." Liu Wenzhu murmured, swallowing the rest of her words, her gaze falling on Ning Fuyi as a look of heartache swiftly passed across her face.

The elders in the back rows also rose one after another. Elder Jingshan gripped his robes tightly and said, "Chuwei Hall? I felt she was incorrigibly mischievous back then. Who would have thought she'd truly consort with evil creatures now!"

"Elder Jingshan, say a few words less!" Elder Pingyao said with a grave expression in a low voice. "The facts are not yet determined. How do you know whom she consorts with?"

"But..."

At this moment, an amplified voice rang out clearly, interrupting the surrounding commotion. Everyone fell silent and looked at the speaker.

Wen Yaojun also seemed extremely surprised, but having witnessed great storms after all, he quickly calmed his expression and spoke: "Your people?"

"We have long suspected that this Chuwei Hall appeared out of nowhere and must have significant origins, but we never imagined it was truly you." Wen Yaojun's hand remained extended. "Ning Fuyi, you've hidden your name and identity, cowering for thirty years. Why are you finally willing to show yourself now?"

"Chuwei Hall is a place where demons and monsters gather. That prophecy was absolutely correct - you are indeed a natural-born demon creature, consorting entirely with evil spirits." He revealed a smile.

Ning Fuyi glanced at him, smiled and shook her head, then raised her hand to strike down. The silver ring immediately lost its force and clattered to the ground. Seeing this, Wen Yaojun raised his hand to retrieve it.

"What consorting with evil spirits? Your Penglai² really knows how to pin labels on me. One hat after another - you're practically helping me break through the heavens!" Ning Fuyi withdrew her right hand to her chest, touching the silver ring between her fingers.

"Tell me, who among those present are the evil spirits? Is it the spirit clan's Du Baishuang? Or is it me?" Ning Fuyi put on an expression of complete incomprehension, turning to smile at him.

"Stop being stubborn!" Wen Yaojun clasped his hands behind his back, his voice like a great bell. "You know what I mean. You harbor demon roots³ within your body and will sooner or later cultivate into a demon that destroys the six realms. That prophecy is crystal clear - there's no escaping it!"

"Bah! Trying to frame someone with empty words - what bullshit prophecy! Today I'll also say I divined a hexagram myself. The hexagram shows that you're the one who will destroy the world. So if I kill you now, am I ridding the people of harm?" Ning Fuyi raised her chin slightly, looking down at him.

"Sophistry! The Star Divination Plate⁴ is an ancient divine artifact. How can your petty tricks compare? This spirit clan member stole magical artifacts, and you bear demon roots. Neither of you will escape today - stop wasting your breath!"

Having said this, he suddenly extended both hands again. The silver ring began spinning between his palms, blowing his robes and hair backward. Then strong winds arose, surging silently toward Ning Fuyi.

"Oh no, Yiyi!" Liu Wenzhu instinctively wanted to stand, but was pulled back by fellow disciples. Then in a flash, they saw Ning Fuyi nonchalantly raise her hand to catch the silver ring, using a gentle force to redirect it. The silver ring immediately lost power and crashed into the crowd with a clatter.

Liu Wenzhu widened her eyes and was pulled back down to sit.

"How does she have such high cultivation now? Facing Penglai people without changing expression!" Those who originally knew Ning Fuyi were all extremely astonished.

High up in the elegant pavilion, several people stood with grave expressions. Hua Hong, who had been watching like a spectator across the river, simply began peeling peanuts to eat: "This cultivation level, if not Great Vehicle Realm then it's Void Comprehension Realm. Thirty years - who was it that said she was dull-witted back then?"

"With such cultivation speed, if she's truly of the demon race and we can't eliminate her this time, I'm afraid we immortal sects will have a hard time ahead."

"I think so too." Li Hanyu frowned tightly, gently stroking the long whip at her waist. "Ordinary people can't cultivate to this level even after a hundred years of practice. Thirty years - if she didn't rely on some unorthodox methods, how could she achieve this?"

Tang Wenshu, who had been gripping his sword hilt with his right hand, remained silent all along before speaking: "But I truly cannot see any demonic aura on her. Besides that prophecy, when has she ever targeted the six realms? For Penglai to pursue a junior to complete destruction based on this alone is truly inappropriate."

Hua Hong tossed a peanut into his mouth, shook the crumbs off his long robes, and smiled while shaking his head: "Sect Master Tang, if you want your sect disciples to live peacefully, then you must set aside such so-called righteousness. In any case, we don't need to get involved - why wade into these muddy waters?"

"But if cultivating immortality isn't for righteousness, then what is it for?" Tang Wenshu countered.

Hua Hong looked at him and said nothing more, only continued smiling as he watched the scene below.

Outside the farce, people's hearts varied; inside the farce, swords were drawn.

Ning Fuyi easily knocked down Wen Yaojun's magical artifact, then finally spun around and descended. Her layered skirts stirred up a breeze that disturbed the candlelight, causing the flames on the high platform to ripple.

Chu Qingqiu, who had been frozen like a statue all along, finally recovered her senses. Her gaze followed Ning Fuyi's descent, her heart beating chaotically.

However, after landing, the woman didn't glance at her once but instead walked lightly to Du Baishuang, raising her hand to cut the chains binding her limbs with swift strikes, then lifted her from the ground.

Ever since the woman appeared, Du Baishuang had stopped crying. She just stared fixedly at Ning Fuyi, and when pulled up by her, a remaining teardrop was shaken off in the wind.

By coincidence, it fell on Chu Qingqiu's foot, soaking her plain white cloth shoes.

Chu Qingqiu shifted her right foot back slightly, staring intently as Du Baishuang grasped the woman's sleeve and hid behind her like a weak willow in the wind, leaning softly against her with her entire heart and soul focused on her.

This scene should have been beautiful, but falling into Chu Qingqiu's eyes it was strangely piercing, so much so that her eyes stung with pain that reached her heart.

She involuntarily wanted to step forward and say something - either her usual scolding or anything else - but the moment she lifted her foot, the woman had already reached out to embrace Du Baishuang and leaped into the air with her.

Black and white robes fluttered in the wind, blocking the candlelight before scattering it again. When the dazzlement passed, the two had already jumped up to the elegant pavilion, leaving only afterimages.

Chu Qingqiu watched for a while longer before realizing that the afterimages were nothing else but the thin tears seeping from her eyes.

Fortunately, no one saw this, so she turned and walked down from the high platform.

The current situation was too chaotic - for the first time, few people paid attention to Chu Qingqiu. Everyone's gaze was focused on the two elegant pavilions.

Wen Yaojun stared fixedly at Ning Fuyi, tapping his right hand twice at his side. Several Penglai immortal soldiers quietly retreated and disappeared from sight.

"Audacious demon creature, do you think that with such petty tricks, you can escape from here? How naive." Wen Yaojun snorted lightly. "Since you've fallen into my Heavenly Mandate Net⁵, even if you have heaven-reaching abilities, you'll find it hard to escape death today!"

Having said this, he suddenly clapped his hands. With the crisp applause, the originally brilliant Danding Manor suddenly went completely dark, even the silver river overhead seemed veiled in black gauze, becoming blurred and unclear.

Everyone looked up and around, seeing a silver light point appear overhead, then slowly spread. Diffusing silver threads wove into a net, slowly descending.

This enormous oppressive feeling caused everyone to panic and scatter. Some disciples turned to flee but found the main doors tightly locked, with silver threads also appearing on the walls, advancing toward everyone.

"Everyone, don't panic. My Penglai never harms immortal sects or immortal friends. This is a magical artifact personally woven by Emperor Tianrui⁶. It can net all demons and monsters under heaven - even the smallest demon root cannot escape this net. But you are all of immortal bodies, so you won't come to harm!" Wen Yaojun's voice echoed throughout Danding Manor, finally calming the disturbance.

Zen Master Feiguang touched a silver thread and felt nothing unusual, so he exchanged glances with the surrounding sect masters and waited to see what would develop.

Ning Fuyi glanced at the Heavenly Mandate Net descending toward her but seemed completely unconcerned, still standing straight. Those watching were all holding their breath with tight hearts, especially Chu Qingqiu who had returned to the elegant pavilion. Seeing this, she quickly summoned her white bone weapon and stood alert.

Perhaps her thoughts were too tense - she didn't notice the presence behind her until that person spoke, causing her to turn around in alarm.

Standing at the door was Jiuying⁷, who had changed back to her original appearance. She leaned against the wall with a beaming smile, her narrow eyes meeting Chu Qingqiu's gaze before looking at the white bone weapon she had summoned, her expression mocking.

"Divine Venerable, don't panic. I came to tell you that you need not worry about her. Since she dared to come, she must have complete confidence." Jiuying's voice drifted.

Chu Qingqiu didn't say she believed or disbelieved. She stood firmly in the darkness and spoke: "Did she send you?"

"No." Jiuying's red lips pressed together lightly, their luster visible even in the darkness. "I just feel that if you truly made a move, it would not only be troublesome for her, but also not very good for yourself and Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate."

Chu Qingqiu's grip on the white bone weapon loosened slightly, and she said nothing.

"I've said all I came to say. Divine Venerable, farewell." Jiuying nodded to her, and her figure quickly disappeared.

Chu Qingqiu gripped harder, and the white bone weapon disappeared in her palm. She suddenly felt a strong sense of powerlessness, stepped back several paces to lean against the wall, and turned her head toward the isolated graceful figure opposite.

Yes, after two lifetimes, she had already transformed to become so powerful. She no longer needed protection.

How wonderful.

On the opposite side, the Heavenly Mandate Net was still descending, quickly touching the top of Ning Fuyi's hair. Yet Ning Fuyi remained unmoved, smiling as she gazed at Wen Yaojun.

Then she watched as the expression of certain victory on Wen Yaojun's face gradually collapsed, replaced by incredulous shock.

The Heavenly Mandate Net had already covered her from head to toe, but showed no unusual signs whatsoever. Then the lights reignited, and brilliant flowing light once again filled Danding Manor. Under everyone's gaze, Ning Fuyi smiled broadly and spread both hands.

An expression of complete innocence, as if mocking.

Footnotes

¹ **Chuwei Hall (憊畏堂)** - The name of Ning Fuyi's organization. "Chuwei" literally means "fear" or "dread."

² **Penglai (蓬萊)** - A legendary immortal island in Chinese mythology, here representing a major immortal sect.

³ **Demon roots (魔根)** - In cultivation fiction, this refers to the inherent potential for demonic cultivation within someone's spiritual essence.

⁴ **Star Divination Plate (占星盤)** - An ancient artifact used for prophecy and divination in the cultivation world.

⁵ **Heavenly Mandate Net (天命網)** - A powerful magical artifact designed to capture and restrain demons and evil creatures.

⁶ **Emperor Tianrui (天瑞帝君)** - A high-ranking immortal emperor in the Penglai hierarchy.

⁷ **Jiuying (九嬰)** - Literally "Nine Infants," one of Ning Fuyi's subordinates with shape-shifting abilities.